MARKETSPILL

Filing cheat sheet

The codes and terms behind every congressional trade report and insider filing, in one place. Keep it open next to the source document.

Congress: the Periodic Transaction Report

STOCK Act	The 2012 law requiring members of Congress to disclose stock trades over $1,000 within 45 days. The disclosures are public, but late filings carry only a $200 penalty.
Periodic Transaction Report (PTR)	The form a lawmaker files to disclose a trade. It shows the asset, the type of transaction, the trade date, the notification date and a dollar range, never an exact amount.
Notification date	On a PTR, the date the lawmaker says they were told about the trade, which can differ from the trade date when a third party manages the account.
Amount range	Congressional filings report trades in bands such as $15,001 to $50,000. The top of the band is not the amount traded.
Spousal trade (SP)	On a PTR, SP means the asset belongs to the lawmaker's spouse. The disclosure is still required, but the decision may not be the lawmaker's.
Joint account (JT)	A PTR owner code for an account held jointly, usually by the lawmaker and a spouse.
Dependent child (DC)	A PTR owner code for assets held by a lawmaker's dependent child.
Partial sale	On a PTR, a sale of some but not all of a holding. The lawmaker still owns the stock afterward.
Exchange (E)	A PTR transaction type for swapping one asset for another, common in fund reallocations.

Insiders: SEC Form 4

Form 4	The SEC filing an officer, director or 10% owner must submit within two business days of buying or selling company stock.
10% owner	Anyone who holds more than 10% of a company's shares. They must file Form 4s like officers and directors do, even if they work for a fund rather than the company.
Transaction code P	On a Form 4, P marks an open-market purchase with the insider's own money, generally the most informative kind of insider trade.
Transaction code S	On a Form 4, S marks an open-market sale. Check the footnotes: many S trades run under a 10b5-1 plan.
Transaction code M	An option exercise or conversion. The insider is turning a derivative into shares, not making a fresh bet.
Transaction code F	Shares withheld by the company to cover taxes when restricted stock vests. It looks like a sale on paper but is routine paperwork.
Gift (G)	A Form 4 code for shares given away, often to a family member or charity. It is a transfer, not a sale.

10b5-1 plan	A pre-arranged trading plan that lets insiders sell on a schedule set months in advance. A sale under one tells you little about today's view of the company.
Indirect ownership	Shares held through a spouse, trust or fund rather than directly. The filer may not have made the decision.
Open-market purchase	A buy made on an exchange at the market price, as opposed to a grant, an award or an option exercise.
Cluster buy	Three or more distinct insiders buying the same company's stock on the open market within a short window. Researchers treat it as a stronger signal than a lone purchase.

Reading the rest

Filing lag	The number of calendar days between a trade and its public disclosure. For Congress it can be 45; for insiders usually two business days.
EDGAR	The SEC's public filing database. Every Form 4 MarketSpill cites links back to its EDGAR record.
Accession number	The unique ID of an EDGAR filing, like a receipt number. Searching it on sec.gov takes you to the original document.
Mentions vs. volume	A Reddit mention is a post or comment, not a trade. A ticker can top the mention charts on a day its trading volume is ordinary.
Short interest	The share of a company's float that has been sold short. High short interest is a precondition for a squeeze, not a prediction of one.

Check any story in a minute

1. Every MarketSpill story links the original filing. Open it before you read our summary.
2. Form 4: find the transaction code column first, then the footnotes. A 10b5-1 note or an F code changes the story.
3. Congress: compare the trade date with the filing date to get the lag, and read the owner code before the member's name.
4. Reddit: a mention count is attention, not money. Look at the base it grew from.

MarketSpill is free to read. Ads and sponsors pay for it and never pick the stories. Software drafts each story from the filing, automated checks compare it with the source, and K. Song answers for every story and correction. Nothing here is investment advice.
marketspill.com